Thistlewood Bank: Account Opening and KYC Guide

What is KYC and why we need it

KYC (Know Your Customer) is the process Thistlewood Bank uses to verify the identity and address of every customer. Banks in India must complete KYC under the Reserve Bank of India's Master Direction on KYC before opening an account or starting an account-based relationship. KYC protects you from identity theft and helps prevent money laundering and fraud.

You need to complete KYC when you open any savings account, current account, fixed deposit, or loan account with Thistlewood Bank. If you already hold an account with us and your KYC is complete, you do not need to repeat it to open a second account.

Documents required for individuals

To open an account you must submit:

- One Officially Valid Document (OVD) as proof of identity and address.
- Your PAN card. If you do not have a PAN, you can submit Form 60 instead.
- One recent passport-size photograph (not needed for Video KYC, where we capture your photo live).

The following are accepted as Officially Valid Documents (OVDs) at Thistlewood Bank:

- Passport
- Driving licence
- Voter ID card issued by the Election Commission of India
- Job card issued under NREGA, signed by a State Government officer
- Letter issued by the National Population Register containing name and address
- Proof of possession of Aadhaar number

An OVD must show your current address. If the address on your OVD is not your current address, you may give a utility bill (electricity, telephone, piped gas or water bill) not older than two months as a temporary address proof, and you must submit an updated OVD within three months.

Aadhaar-based KYC

If you choose to use Aadhaar, you can complete e-KYC using an OTP sent to the mobile number linked to your Aadhaar. You can also give offline Aadhaar verification (a digitally signed XML or QR code). We never store your full Aadhaar number; only the last four digits are visible to our staff.

Using Aadhaar is voluntary. You can always use any other OVD from the list above.

Central KYC (CKYC) number

If you have completed KYC with any bank or financial institution in India before, you may already have a 14-digit CKYC Identifier, also called KIN. Share your KIN with us and we will download your KYC records from the Central KYC Records Registry (CKYCR), so you may not need to submit documents again. We will still verify your mobile number and take a live photograph.

Small account (for customers without OVDs)

If you do not have any OVD, you can open a small account by giving a self-attested photograph and signing or putting your thumb impression in the presence of a bank officer. A small account has these limits:

- Balance at any time: up to Rs 50,000
- Total credits in a financial year: up to Rs 1,00,000
- Total withdrawals and transfers in a month: up to Rs 10,000

A small account is valid for 12 months. It can be extended for another 12 months if you show that you have applied for an OVD.

Minors

A savings account for a minor under 10 years is opened and operated by a parent or legal guardian. We need the minor's birth certificate or an OVD, and full KYC documents of the guardian. Minors aged 10 years and above may operate their account independently, with limits on withdrawals.

Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)

NRIs can open NRE and NRO accounts. Required documents are: a valid passport, a valid visa or overseas residence permit, proof of overseas address, PAN card or Form 60, and a recent photograph. Documents signed outside India must be attested by an Indian embassy, a notary, or an overseas branch of an Indian bank.

How long does it take?

- Branch account opening: your account is usually activated within 1 working day after document verification.
- Video KYC: your account is usually activated within 4 working hours after a successful video call.
- CKYC-based account opening: usually activated on the same working day.

You will receive your account number by SMS and email, and your debit card by post within 7 working days.

Need help?

Call Thistlewood Bank customer care on 1800-000-0000 (toll-free, 8 AM to 10 PM, all days) or email support@thistlewood.example.